

Prompt Engineering for Non-Developers

Audience Analysis

Section 1: Professional Role Identification

The first step in reader analysis for this project was to research and identify likely professional roles for each reader type. This identification provided a starting point for the writer-centered analysis and in-depth reader analysis worksheets.

The professional roles listed below are those most likely to perform or have a stake in job responsibilities related to generative artificial intelligence. They are organized by reader types.

Primary Reader Professions

- Technical writers
- Instructional designers
- Content strategists
- Research analysts
- Compliance writers

Secondary Reader Professions

- Technical and engineering team leads
- Generative AI engineers
- Data scientists
- Prompt engineers
- Generative AI power users

Tertiary Reader Professions

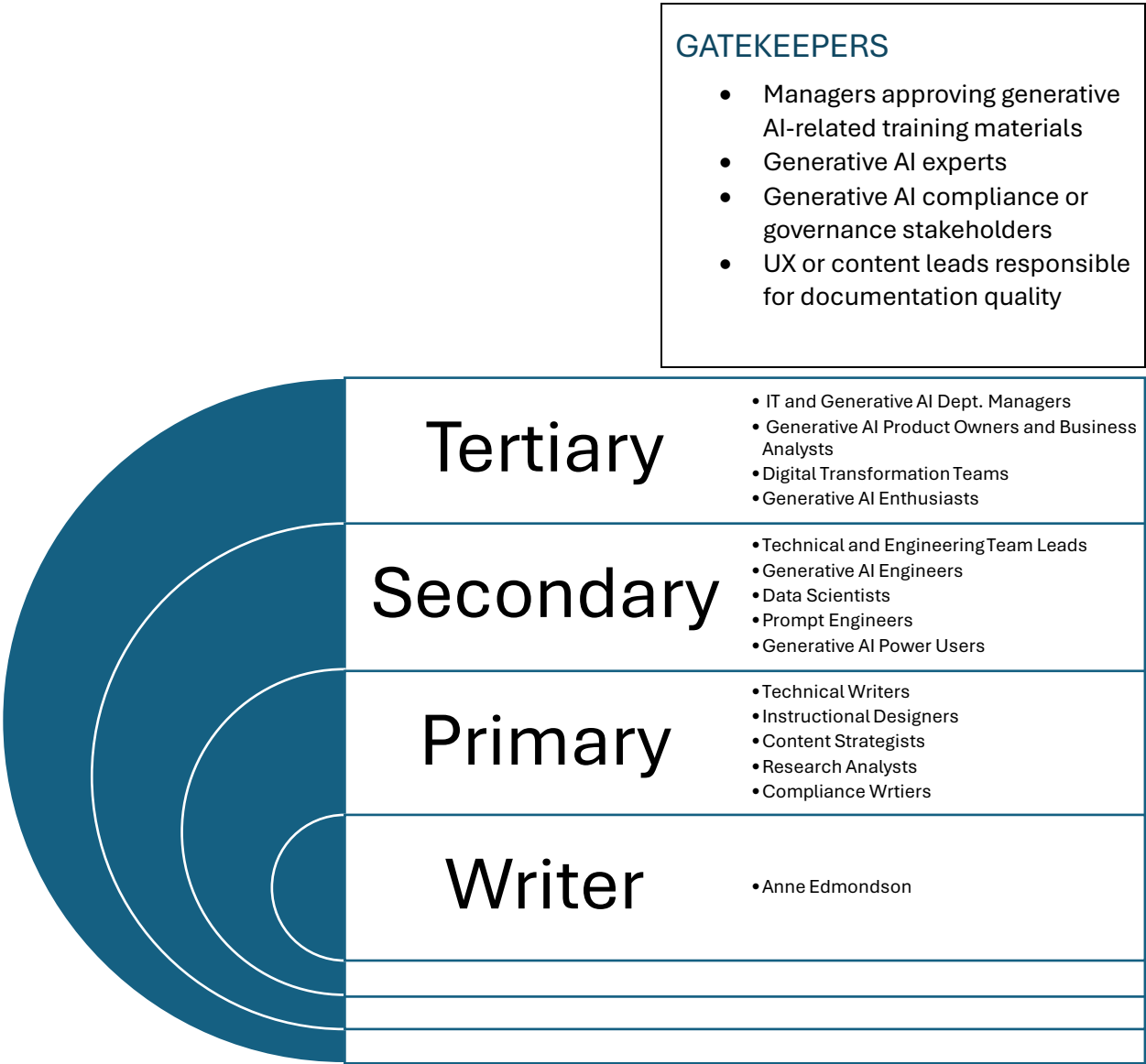
- IT and generative AI-related department managers
- Generative AI product owners
- Generative AI business analysts
- Digital transformation teams
- Generative AI enthusiasts

Gatekeeper Professions

- Managers approving generative AI-related training materials
- Generative AI experts
- Generative AI compliance or governance stakeholders
- UX or content leads responsible for documentation quality

Section 2: Reader Analysis Worksheets

Writer-Centered Analysis Worksheet



Reader Analysis Worksheet

	NEEDS	VALUES	ATTITUDES
PRIMARY READERS	Immediate, applicable techniques for improvement of AI outputs Clear examples showing before/after prompt improvements Platform-agnostic strategies Guidance on avoiding common pitfalls Guidance on evaluating AI output quality Quick reference material they can return to repeatedly	Efficiency and productivity Practicality Clear communication Professional credibility Responsible technology use Quality and accuracy Consistency and reliability in their work	Frustration with inconsistent or low-quality results Skeptical of overly technical solutions Time-conscious Pragmatic Cautiously optimistic about AI but aware of its limitations Concerned about maintaining professional standards Curiosity about generative AI Cautious about ethics Motivated by immediate improvement and usefulness
SECONDARY	Material they can share or use for instruction Understanding of how the guide fits with other skill development Evidence that they and primary readers	Support for peer success and development Resource quality and effectiveness High ROI on time investment Credible, well-researched content	Desire to enable others Evaluative and selective Cautious about recommendations

	can successfully apply the content Clarity on time investment required	Alignment with organizational or professional standards Responsible AI practices	
TERTIARY	Confidence that generative AI can be used productively and responsibly Evidence that guide is practical and scalable	Productivity gains Risk mitigation Clear communication	Interested in generative AI's potential business value Focused on outcomes rather than technical implementation
GATEKEEPERS	Evidence of thorough research and audience analysis Clear organization and professional presentation Accuracy and credibility of information Appropriate scope and depth for intended audience Proper citations/attribution Alignment with academic or professional standards Assurance that the documentation supports employee productivity without	Academic/professional rigor and standards Clear, effective communication High-quality technical writing Ethical considerations Completeness and thoroughness Risk mitigation and compliance Operational efficiency Employee skill development Organizational credibility and reputation	Supportive but evaluative Looking for evidence of learning and skill application Value thoughtful audience consideration Value constructive feedback Pragmatic and outcome-focused Sensitive to legal, ethical, and reputational concerns

	increasing organizational risk Alignment with company policies around data privacy, ethics, and responsible AI use Reusable content for onboarding, training, or other internal needs		
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Reader Context Analysis Worksheet

	PHYSICAL CONTEXT	MOBILE CONTEXT	ECONOMIC CONTEXT	ETHICAL CONTEXT
PRIMARY READERS	Working at desks or home offices Using laptops or desktop computers Often multitasking while referencing documentation May print the quick-reference checklist for desk reference	Occasional access via tablets or phones	Majority are employed professionals Time is money - learning must translate to improved efficiency Poor AI outputs waste time on editing and revisions Better prompting skills result in faster turnaround on deliverables Career advancement may depend on effectively leveraging AI tools Organizations are increasingly expecting AI proficiency Free resources preferred (no budget for specialized training)	Concerned about maintaining professional integrity when using AI-generated content Must consider accuracy and fact-checking responsibilities Need guidance on data privacy Want to use AI as a tool, not a replacement for expertise Concerned about transparency about AI use

			ROI must be quick and measurable	
READER ORGANIZATIONS	Corporate offices, educational institutions, or consultant environments May have informal or unclear AI training resources and usage guidelines Actively experimenting with generative AI			
READER INDUSTRIES	Business Education Communications Information Technology Engineering			

Section 3: Audience's Desired Outcome

Members of the primary audience for this deliverable want to quickly learn how to write more effective prompts without having to master generative AI technology or learn how to code.

Primary readers want:

- More consistent and reliable results from generative AI
- Decreased frustration and wasted time caused by poor generative AI outputs
- Clear, step-by-step guidance they can apply immediately
- Examples that mirror real workplace tasks
- Strategies for refining prompts and evaluating outputs
- Reassurance about responsible and ethical AI use

Section 4: Deliverable Outline

Table of Contents

Introduction

Who this guide is for

Summary of guide contents

Why Prompts Matter

What is prompt engineering

Challenges and misconceptions

How better prompts lead to better results

Step-by-Step: Writing a Better Prompt

Define goal

Assign role

Specify task

Add constraints

Provide context or examples

Ask for revision

Prompt Examples

Summarizing a document

Original Prompt

Faulty output

Refined prompt

Improved output

Drafting an email

Original Prompt

Faulty output

Refined prompt

Improved output

Explaining a complex technical concept

Original Prompt

Faulty output

Refined prompt

Improved output

Brainstorming ideas

Original Prompt

Faulty output

Refined prompt

Improved output

Refining Through Iteration

How to improve without starting over

Common Prompting Mistakes

Being vague

How to fix

Asking for too much at once

How to fix

Forgetting the audience

How to fix

Over-trusting answers

How to fix

Evaluating AI Output

Evaluation questions

Need for human review and decision-making

Responsible Prompting

Avoid using sensitive data

Don't include proprietary information

Fact-check with rigor

Disclose use of AI

Cheat Sheet (standalone)

Prompt Template

Prompt Writing Checklist

Refining Phrases

Appendix

Glossary

Additional Resources